GRE RETAKE DECISION WORKSHEET

Score Gap Audit, Section Deficit Diagnostics, Realistic Point Projection & 21-Day Retake Roadmap

1. Program Score Benchmark & Deficit Audit

Quantify your score differential against admission targets for top-tier MS, Engineering, and MBA programs.

Target Degree / Program Track	Median GRE Composite	Competitive Quant / Verbal Split	Retake Recommendation Threshold
Top 10 US MS Computer Science / AI	330 - 334	Quant: 168 - 170 | Verbal: 158 - 162	Retake if Quant < 167 or Composite < 326
Top 15 US MS Data Science / Analytics	325 - 330	Quant: 166 - 169 | Verbal: 156 - 160	Retake if Quant < 165 or Composite < 322
M7 & Elite Global MBA (Stanford, Wharton, INSEAD)	326 - 332	Quant: 164 - 167 | Verbal: 162 - 166	Retake if either section < 160 or Composite < 324
Top 25 Engineering MS (Mech, EE, Civil)	318 - 325	Quant: 163 - 167 | Verbal: 152 - 156	Retake if Quant < 162 or Composite < 315
Top 30 Public Policy / Humanities / Law	322 - 328	Quant: 154 - 158 | Verbal: 164 - 168	Retake if Verbal < 162 or Composite < 320

Guideline: If your current score is 4+ points below your target program median, a retake yields significant ROI.

2. Error Diagnosis: Repeatable Gaps vs Random Execution Flaws

Determine whether your previous attempt underperformed due to knowledge gaps or addressable test-day factors.

Diagnostic Failure Dimension	Root Cause Analysis	Expected Score Gain With Targeted Fix
Pacing & Clock Freeze (Rushed last 4 questions)	Poor time-budgeting on early difficult problems	+3 to +5 Points within 2 to 3 weeks of section drills
QC & Word Problem Trap Vulnerability	Testing only positive integers; missing hidden constraints	+3 to +4 Quant Points through elimination protocols
Sentence Equivalence Synonym Blindness	Synonym hunting without textual clue matching	+2 to +4 Verbal Points with tone analysis techniques
Test-Day Anxiety & Sleep Deprivation	Adrenaline crash during Module 2 adaptive sections	+2 to +4 Points via test conditioning and simulation
Foundational Concept Deficits (e.g. Combinatorics)	Unfamiliarity with core mathematical theory	+4 to +7 Points requiring 4 to 6 weeks structured rebuild

Retake Rule: Never book a retake without fixing the specific behavioral or conceptual root cause.

3. The 4-Week Structured Retake Execution Roadmap

Week-by-week action plan to ensure your second attempt delivers a decisive score breakthrough.

- Week 1: Forensic Diagnostic Audit. Review your official ETS score diagnostic, categorize every error type, and rebuild identified topic weaknesses.
- Week 2: Pacing & Sectional Mastery. Drill 12-question and 15-question timed modules enforcing strict 1-minute Quant and 45-second SE time caps.
- Week 3: Full Simulation & Retake Booking. Take 2 full-length official PowerPrep computer-adaptive mocks; register for test date (respecting 21-day rule).
- Week 4: Peak Tapering & Test-Day Rituals. Audit your active error log, complete light mental math drills, optimize sleep schedule, and execute test day.